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The team that gave India its Olympic footprint will be missing from the Beijing Olympics. Run by autocratic officials who turn away world class support, India's Olympian trauma is self-inflicted.



AP Photo MOBI RTO CANDIA

*1940, 1944 Games not held

1968	1964	1960	1956	1952	1948	1936	1932	1928
MEXICO CITY	TOKYO	ROME	MELBOURNE	HELSINKI	LONDON	BERLIN	LOS ANGELES	AMSTERDAM
BRONZE	GOLD	SILVER	GOLD	GOLD	GOLD	GOLD	GOLD	GOLD



PHOTOGRAPH BY MADHU BHASKAR

INDIAN HOCKEY'S TENURE OF TRAUMA

K.P.S. GILL, IHF PRESIDENT SINCE 1994

- During his tenure the national hockey championships have only been held five times.
- Since 1994, India has changed 18 coaches in just 14 years and has fielded 12-14 new players every year leading to a lack of stability and continuity in the team.
- In 1997, IHF signed a 10-year contract with Star Sports which was abandoned after six months. IHF then partnered with Doordarshan which also dumped the hockey federation within three years.
- When India won its first Asian Games gold medal after 32 years in 1998 in Bangkok, IHF sacked the six senior-most players and the coach.
- In 2001, India won the junior World Cup with a team that the International Hockey Federation (FIH) president called the most talented team to come out of India in the last two decades. The core of that team has now been decimated.
- In 2002, coach Cedric

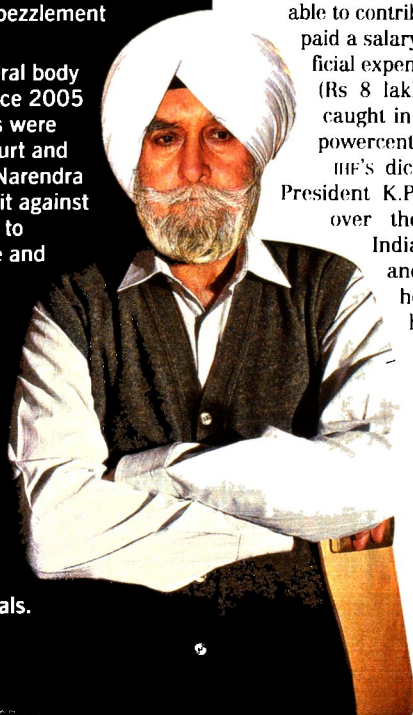
D'Souza was sacked in the middle of the World Championships in Kuala Lumpur.

■ In 2004, Rajinder Singh was sacked 18 days before the Athens Olympics. He was replaced by unknown German Gerhard Rach, who had a trail of financial embezzlement behind him.

■ The IHF general body has not met since 2005 after the results were contested in court and vice-president Narendra Batra filed a writ against Gill with regard to length of tenure and financial irregularities.

■ In 2005, the FIH chief terms IHF as the worst run hockey association in the world.

■ In 2006, India failed to make the Asian Games semi-finals.



paying for) Charlesworth's appointment as technical director and catalyst for change. Arguably the game's finest tactician and thinker today, Charlesworth organised a series of matches for the Indians at his home base in Perth, was due to work with the Indian women's team in Lucknow before leaving for Chile, but has been left steaming in Australia with no ticket.

Carvalho has denied blocking Charlesworth's travel to Chile and the Aussie said, "I'm frustrated that I wasn't able to contribute." Today, neither paid a salary nor reimbursed official expenses close to \$20,000 (Rs 8 lakh). Charlesworth is caught in an IHF cold war, its powercentre in a flux.

IHF's dictatorial but ageing President K.P.S. Gill has lorded over the worst years in Indian hockey (see box) and is today said to be heavily dependant on his security officer Suresh Sharma, who is virtually the acting IHF chief. Gill hardly speaks to his once-trusted secretary, K. Jothikumaran who is allegedly running a parallel IHF in Chennai.

Unhappy with